> woman. Can you imagine! I have never seen such a cultural, familial outrage, and the destruction they have left, those who did this, affected the whole family.[9]

In order to tackle the allegations, the Clínica Ambiental (Environmental Clinic) of Ecuador conducted a multi-disciplinary investigation of the psychosocial impacts caused by the Chinese company. Among the report's conclusions, the following stands out:

> The presence of workers in the SINOPEC firm triggered the consumption of alcohol among adolescents, adults and women to the detriment of family relations and increased intra-family violence including accusations of jealousy, abandonment, maltreatment and physical and psychological violence. The family fabric, already feeble, underwent fragmentation, mistrust and an increase of fear. The firm just fired some of the workers because they were unable to do their work but did not worry how this would affect the community and never attempted to correct its workers on its own initiative. Given that China and Ecuador are signatories to Convention 169 of the ILO, SINOPEC demonstrated grave irresponsibility in the way it treated this Indian nationality (Clíncia Ambiental 2013).

It needs to be added that, besides attempting to obtain the majority of oil concessions and to save the most possible costs, the Chinese companies showed little respect for the collective, the workforce and the environment. In summary, we read from the official website that 'Andes Petroleum Ecuador Ltd. operates in the Tarapoa Block and in the Lago Agrio Storage and Transfer Station (Sucumbios). PetroOriental SA operates in Blocks 14 and 17 (Orellana). Andes Petroleum Ecuador Ltd. and PetroOriental SA are companies formed with capital coming from state companies of the People's Republic of China. These are: China National Petroleum Corporation (CNPC) whose equity participation is 55% and China Petrochemical Corporation (SINOPEC), which holds the remaining 45%' (Clíncia Ambiental 2013). In addition, CNPC holds 36.26% of the Crude Oil Pipeline (OCP) shares.

To conclude, in November 2013 CNPC, through its subsidiary Andes Petroleum, put itself forward for Blocks 79 and 83 in the XI Round of Petroleum Tenders in the southeast of Ecuador. This is how Chinese oil firms are present in Ecuador, either as direct operators or as shareholders.